Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — President: election, impeachment, powers and functions

Indian Government & Politics · Unit 3 · Chapter President: election, impeachment, powers and functions

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Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

The President is the constitutional head of the Union and is elected indirectly by an electoral college defined by the Constitution.

1. The term is five years. Article 61 sets out impeachment for violation of the Constitution, requiring a special parliamentary procedure.

2. Powers include formal executive appointments, legislative functions, specified pardoning powers, diplomatic and defence roles, and constitutional emergency functions.

3. Under the parliamentary system, the President ordinarily acts on the aid and advice of the Council of Ministers, subject to the Constitution and applicable provisions.

4. The office combines formal constitutional authority with duties to preserve, protect and defend the Constitution.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?